

A comparison of network monitoring tools

Name	Observium	Ganglia	Nagios	Zenoss
Platform	PHP	C, PHP	C, PHP	Python, Java
Licence	QPL, commercial	BSD	GPL	Free Core GPL, commercial enterprise
Latest release version	Continuous rolling release	3.7.1	4.0.8	4.2.5
Auto discovery	Yes	Via gmond check in	Via plug-in	Yes
Agentless	Supported	No	Supported	Supported
Syslog	Yes	No	Via plugin	Yes
SNMP	Yes	Via plugin	Via plugin	Yes
Triggers / Alerts	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
WebApp	Full control	Viewing	Yes	Full control
Distributed monitoring	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Inventory	Yes	Unknown	Via plugin	Yes
Data storage method	RRDtool, MySQL	RRDtool	Flat file, SQL	ZODB, MySQL, RRDtool
Access control	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
IPv6	Yes	Unknown	Yes	Yes
Maps	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Logical grouping	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Trend prediction	No	No	No	Yes
Plugins	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

A few global users of Observium

1. Web4all.fr	This French Web hosting provider uses Observium to monitor its entire network and server infrastructure
2. ICANN	ICANN uses Observium to monitor L-Root instances
3. Jersey Telecom	Jersey Telecom uses Observium to monitor its IP/MPLS, data centre and VoIP platforms
4. Vostron	Vostron uses Observium to monitor its IP/MPLS, data centre and VoIP networks
5. Altercom	Altercom uses Observium to monitor its national VoIP network infrastructure
6. ThinFactory	ThinFactory uses Observium to monitor its cloud services and IP/MPLS infrastructure
7. Boxed IT Ltd	Boxed IT Ltd uses Observium to monitor its network and server infrastructure
8. SupraNet	SupraNet uses Observium to monitor its cloud services and IP/MPLS infrastructure

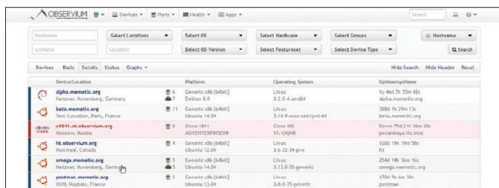


Figure 4: Device information

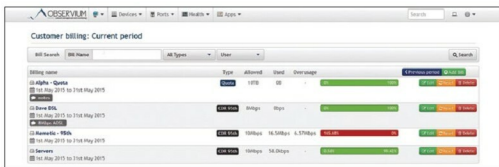


Figure 5: Traffic Accounting

Go to the **Health** menu and click on **Memory** to get information regarding devices, memory, usage, etc (Figure 6).

To get polling information and discovery timing, go to the main menu and select **Polling Information** (Figure 7).

Features of Observium

- Auto-discovery of SNMP based network monitoring tool
- Application monitoring, using SNMP
- Includes support for network hardware and operating systems such as Cisco, Juniper, Linux, FreeBSD, Foundry, etc.
- Metrics supported: CPU, memory, storage, IPv4, IPv6, TCP and UDP stack statistics, MAC/IP, users, processes,